RICOCHET
ASSOCIATION TRANSFORMATION

How does my association's performance compare to membership benchmarks?

See where you stand

These benchmarks come from the 2026 Membership Marketing Benchmarking Report by Marketing General Incorporated, split by individual and trade associations. Find your own numbers for each row, then see where you lead and where you lag.

FIVE IMPORTANT METRICS

Overall retention rate	1st-year retention rate	Automatic card renewal	Increased rate in 2025	Welcome in week 1
79% Individual / 88% Trade	61% Individual / 82% Trade	58% Individual / 21% Trade	49% Individual / 53% Trade	74% Individual / 64% Trade

THE 20 BENCHMARKS

Benchmark	Individual	Trade
DUES		
Rate set by member category	77%	20%
Rate set by revenue or size	3%	64%
Increased rate in 2025	49%	53%
Last increase was 1% to 5%	54%	65%
RECRUITMENT		
Intro dues rate, students/YP	52%	13%
1st-year rate discount	26%	24%
Monthly or quarterly installments	23%	18%
Multi-year rate discount	17%	9%
ONBOARDING		
Welcome contact in week one	74%	64%
30-day check-in	20%	30%
90-day engagement session	12%	24%
None	14%	18%

Benchmark	Individual	Trade
RETENTION		
Overall retention rate	79%	88%
1st-year retention rate	61%	82%
Retention rate of 80% or higher	50%	87%
RENEWAL OPS		
Automatic card renewal	58%	21%
Bill-me renewal	19%	41%
Renewal calls per member	2 to 3	4
2- or 3-month grace period	38%	52%
No grace period	26%	15%

OTHER 2026 BENCHMARKS

- **66%** report a 1st-year renewal rate of 80% or higher iMIS
- **3 in 4** held or raised overall retention iMIS
- **34%** raised dues in 2026, up from 13.8% in 2025 ASAE

Sources: MGI 2026 Membership Marketing Benchmarking Report; iMIS 2026 Membership Performance Benchmark Report; ASAE 2026 State of Associations.

RICOCHET ASSOCIATION TRANSFORMATION

Why work with Ricochet?

Deep bench
Specialists in marketing, membership, project management, data, systems integration and AI.

Fluent in your stack
Hands-on with the marketing automation, AMS and AI platforms associations use, so we fit each to your goals.

Been in your seat
We have worked on association staff and consulted with dozens of associations. Many of us hold industry credentials.

For 10 years, Ricochet has worked only with professional and trade associations on marketing, communications, technology and data. Chief Consultant Chris Gloede, CAE, was the first Chief Marketing Officer of the American Bar Association.

Meet with us

www.ricochetadvice.com

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